

Loops and Stopping

Project: Transparent Book Recommender

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can trace variable values before and after each loop iteration.

I can use the excluded stop value in range correctly.

I can explain initialization and test zero one and several iterations.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

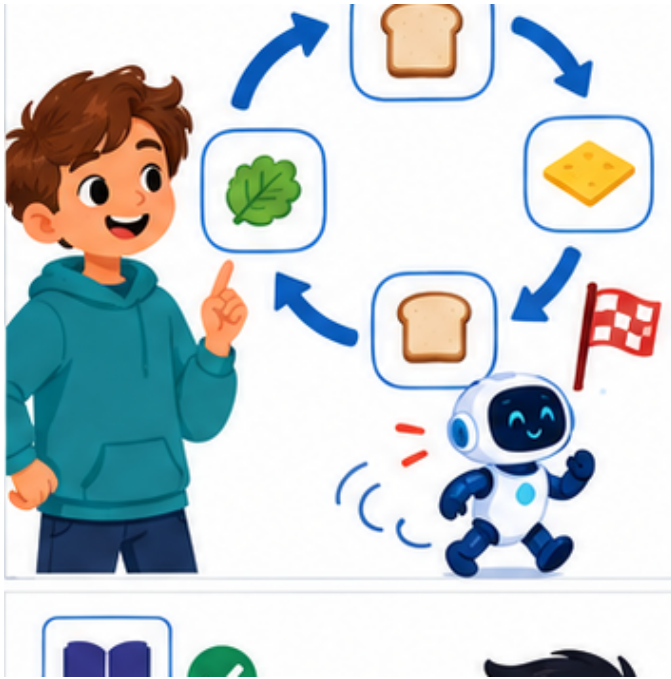
Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Trace Tables. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Decompose a Goal. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

Week 5: Loops and Stopping

Useful repetition needs a clear update and stopping rule.



THINKER MISSION

Predict loop counts; repair one infinite loop.

Thinker name and date:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Readiness for the connected explanation

Starting with $\text{total} = 2$, what does $\text{total} = \text{total} + 3$ store?

This week's end goal

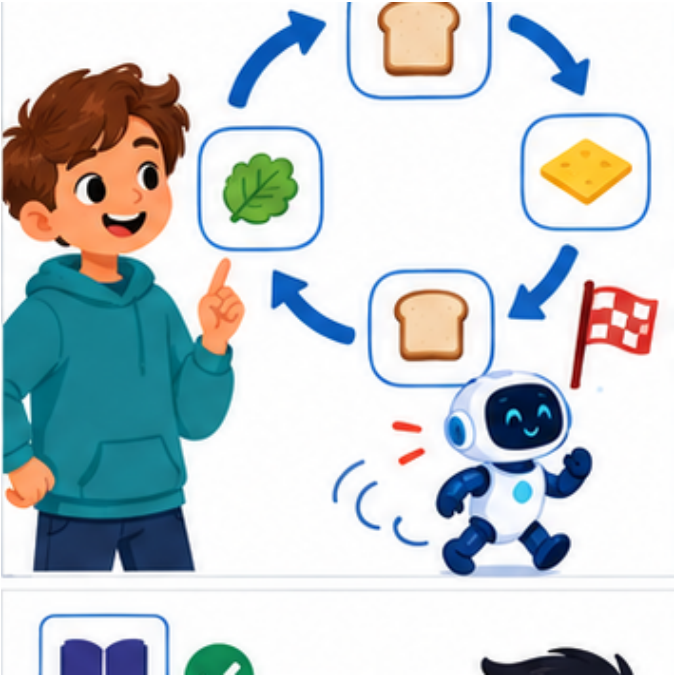
By the end, I can trace a while-loop and recognise when its update cannot satisfy the stopping test.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Notice → Predict → Explain

Begin with visible evidence. Do not explain more than the picture and information support.



MYSTERY

The learners must use loops and stopping to solve a problem. What information do they have? What decision or calculation do they make? What would count as evidence that it worked?

Three observations (what you can point to):

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

My prediction and the clue supporting it:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

Imagine adding numbered counters: first 1, then 2, then 3. A loop can repeat the same addition with a different number each time. This week you will predict each change before running a short Python script. Tracing repeated calculations prepares you to inspect the data processing used in larger AI applications.

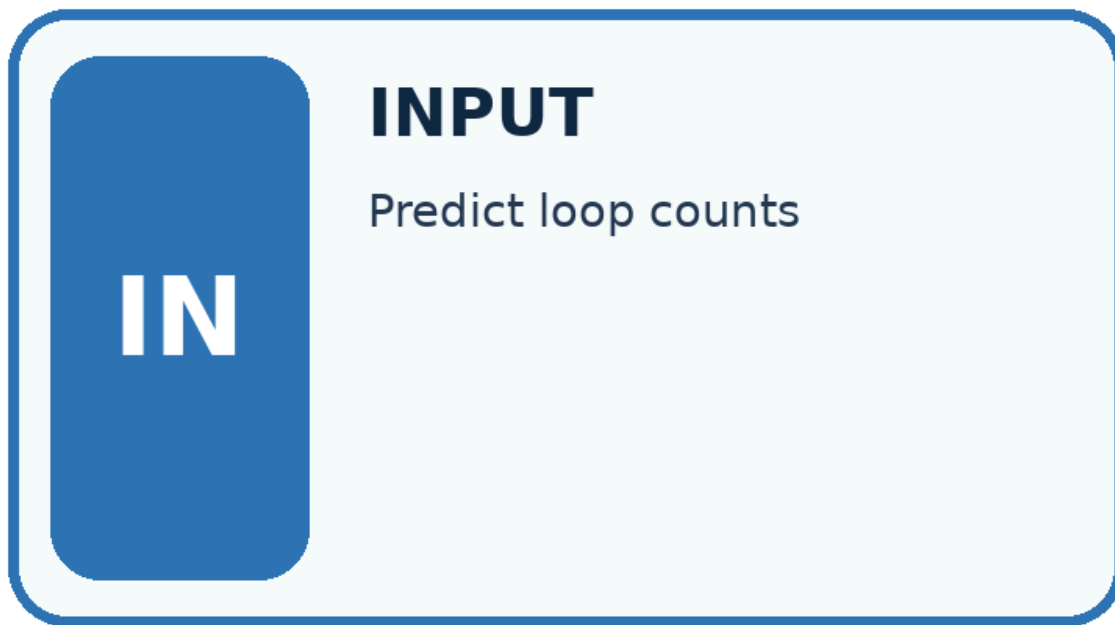
In for turn in `range(1, 4)`, Python supplies 1, 2 and 3 in order. The start is included and the stop is excluded. The indented body runs once for each supplied value. The colon and four-space indentation mark that body. This lesson uses integer range values with the default positive step of 1.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.





PROCESS

Useful repetition needs a clear update and stopping rule.





OUTPUT

repair one infinite loop.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

```
total = 0

for turn in range(1, 4):
    total = total + turn

print(total)
```

State after each addition

turn	total before	total after
------	--------------	-------------

turn: 1		
---------	--	--

total before: 0		
-----------------	--	--

total after: 1		
----------------	--	--

turn: 2		
---------	--	--

total before: 1		
-----------------	--	--

total after: 3		
----------------	--	--

turn: 3		
---------	--	--

total before: 3		
-----------------	--	--

total after: 6		
----------------	--	--

Initialize total to 0 before the loop. The unindented print runs once afterward.

The output is 6. Before the first iteration, total is 0. Each assignment reads the previous total and adds the current turn. After turn 3, the range is exhausted, so execution continues after the loop. The table records state; it does not create extra instructions.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

4. Compare the cases

CASE GALLERY

Four Tests, Four Kinds of Evidence

A system is not understood until it survives more than one comfortable example.



NORMAL
Expected everyday case



BOUNDARY
Near a decision edge

NORMAL CASE: predict and name evidence. BOUNDARY CASE: predict and name evidence.



MISSING

Needed information absent



TRANSFER

Fresh situation or user

MISSING INFORMATION: predict and name evidence. TRANSFER CASE: predict and name evidence.

Which case is most likely to reveal a hidden assumption? Why?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Replace `count>3` with `count!=3`.

Prediction: From 12, the loop never reaches 3 and does not terminate in this toy model.

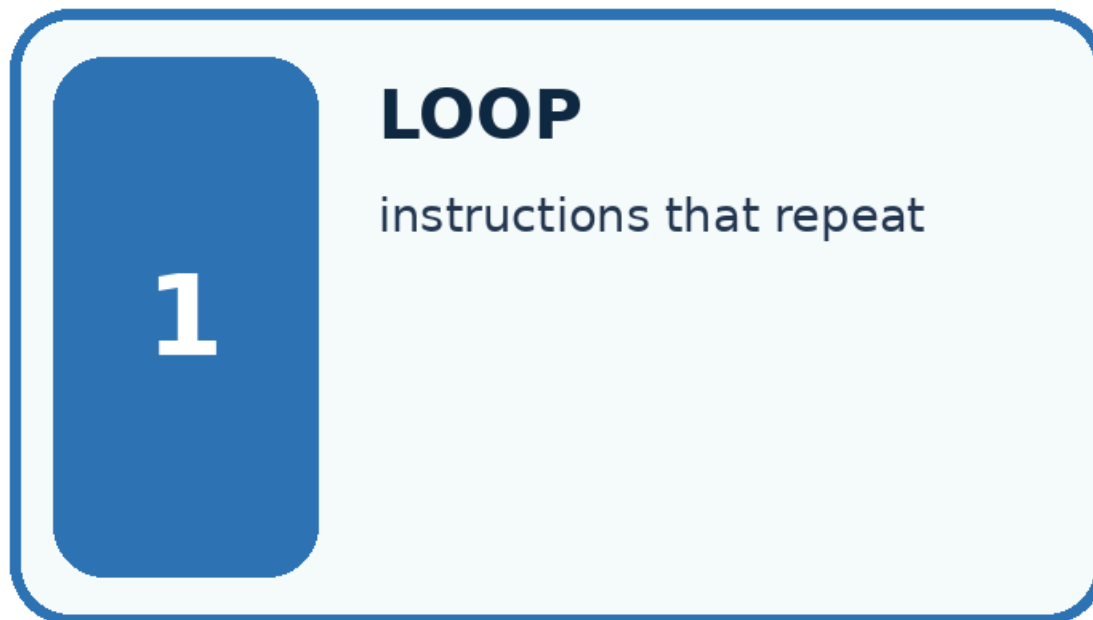
Reason: 12,8,4,0,-4,... are multiples of 4; none equals 3.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY LAB

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.



2

UPDATE

a change made each repetition

3

STOPPING RULE

condition that ends repetition

4

INFINITE LOOP

repetition that never reaches a stop

Word · My own example · Not this / boundary

Word: loop

My own example: A structure that repeats instructions according to a count or condition.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: update

My own example: Change a stored value or state according to a specified operation or new evidence.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: stopping rule

My own example: A specified condition that ends a repeated process.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: infinite loop

My own example: A loop that never reaches its stopping condition under the assumed execution model.

Not this / boundary: _____

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Iteration

Meaning: One execution of a loop body

Word: Accumulator

Meaning: A variable that keeps a running result

Word: Initialization

Meaning: Giving a variable its starting value

Word: Trace table

Meaning: A record of variable values as instructions execute

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EVIDENCE

Reason Step by Step

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

WEEK 5 • WORKED EVIDENCE

- 1 Start count = 0.
- 2 Repeat while count < 4: show a card; count = count + 1.
- 3 The loop runs 4 times and stops when count becomes 4.
- 4 If count never changes, the stopping condition never becomes false.

1. Start count = 0.

2. Repeat while count < 4: show a card; count = count + 1.

3. The loop runs 4 times and stops when count becomes 4.

4. If count never changes, the stopping condition never becomes false.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

A closer explanation

Range expression · Values supplied · Number of iterations

Range expression: range(1, 4)

Values supplied: 1, 2, 3

Number of iterations: 3

Range expression: range(1, 2)

Values supplied: 1

Number of iterations: 1

Range expression: range(1, 1)

Values supplied: No values

Number of iterations: 0

Range expression: range(4)

Values supplied: 0, 1, 2, 3

Number of iterations: 4

With one argument, range starts at zero. range(4) supplies four values but none is 4. If the worked script uses range(1, 1), the body never runs and the initialized total remains 0. Do not rely on a variable first assigned inside a loop: a zero-iteration run might never assign it.

Replace range(1, 4) with range(1, 3) in the worked script. Predict the supplied values and final total. What stop value is needed to include 3?

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Loops and Stopping

A fictional counter starts at 12 and decreases while above a boundary.

The facts we will use

Python: count=12; while count>3: count=count-4; print after the loop.

The condition is checked before each subtraction.

Loops and Stopping

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Initial check

$12 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 8.



2. Next check

$8 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 4.



3. Final update

$4 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 0.



4. Stop

$0 > 3$ is false; report 0 after three updates.

CHANGE ONE THING

Replace $\text{count} > 3$ with $\text{count} \neq 3$.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Initial check

What happens and why: $12 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 8.

Step: 2. Next check

What happens and why: $8 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 4.

Step: 3. Final update

What happens and why: $4 > 3$: true; subtract 4 to get 0.

Step: 4. Stop

What happens and why: $0 > 3$ is false; report 0 after three updates.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

The condition does not promise the counter ends exactly at 3. Subtractions can cross the boundary. The count strictly decreases, so the below-or-equal stopping region is eventually reached from this start. A condition requiring exact equality can be unsafe when repeated updates skip that value.

What this example does not establish

Do not run an intentionally unbounded loop in class; trace a finite prefix to inspect the defect safely.

7. Find and repair a mistake

ERROR DETECTIVE

Compare → Diagnose → Repair

Do not patch the answer. Find the earliest unsupported assumption, wrong step, or weak evidence.



COMPARE • DIAGNOSE

Weak idea: Every repeated action will eventually stop by itself. Strong move: locate evidence, change one cause, and retest.

Evidence record · Expected · Actual · Likely cause / next test

Evidence record: normal case

Expected: works

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: boundary case

Expected: stated rule

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: missing input

Expected: safe response

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: fresh transfer

Expected: generalizes

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Repair one cause. Why is this repair better than changing several things?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

Write the expected range values and trace table before running. Keep predicted and observed output separate, then explain the first row where they differ. For a loop that should add a fixed amount repeatedly, zero iterations should preserve the initial amount. One iteration checks one update; several check accumulation.

A learner checks the reset bug using only range(1, 2) and sees the expected answer 1. Explain why this does not establish correctness, and give a revealing test with its expected correct output.

8. Practise together

LOGIC STUDIO

Trace Before You Run

Block code, pseudocode, tables, and diagrams are different ways to expose the same reasoning.



TRACE THE LOGIC

Predict the result. Trace every condition or calculation. Compare expected with actual. Explain the first difference.

SET evidence_record PREDICT expected_result RUN one normal case and one boundary case
COMPARE actual_result with expected_result IF different: locate first cause; change one factor; RETEST
EXPLAIN result, limitation, and next safe step

Trace one input. Which line changes the state or chooses a path?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

```
total = 0

for turn in range(1, 4):
    total = 0
    total = total + turn

print(total)
```

This faulty version prints 3. The extra reset discards earlier additions on every iteration. Remove the indented reset while keeping initialization before the loop. Then test zero, one and several iterations: the one-iteration case alone cannot reveal this reset bug.

Moving `print(total)` into the correct loop produces three lines, 1 then 3 then 6. Moving it out produces only the final 6. Trace both values and output events. A loop follows written instructions; repeating them does not make the program learn.

Practise with less help: Trace before running

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Loops and trace tables”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Loops and trace tables. Proposed explanation: “The stop value is included”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Why is report 0 correct for the original loop, and why is equality-only stopping risky here?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EVIDENCE LAB

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.



PREDICT → TEST → RECORD → EXPLAIN
Walk a robot around a four-card loop. Record the update each time; remove the update to observe the failure; restore it and retest.

Walk a robot around a four-card loop. Record the update each time; remove the update to observe the failure; restore it and retest.

Test / input · Prediction · Actual · Evidence / calculation · Change or keep?

Test / input: normal

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: boundary

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: missing

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: fresh transfer

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Plan → try → check

Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

MASTERY

From Knowing the Word to Owning the Idea

Move upward only when you can produce evidence without copying the worked example.



MASTERY LADDER

1 Name it • 2 Trace it • 3 Apply it • 4 Challenge it • 5 Explain limits

1 • NAME: Define the concept without repeating the textbook.

2 • TRACE: Show the information, state, branch, calculation, or evidence path.

3 • APPLY: Solve a different example independently.

4 • CHALLENGE: Find a boundary case, counterexample, or unfair outcome.

5 • EXPLAIN LIMITS: Say when the result should not be trusted or used alone.

My strongest evidence of independent understanding:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

11. Connect your project

CUMULATIVE PROJECT

Transparent Book Recommender

Every week adds one inspectable piece. The system must show how it reached a result.



TRANSPARENT BOOK RECOMMENDER

Loop through every candidate book, update its score, then stop at the end of the list.

THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Loop through every candidate book, update its score, then stop at the end of the list.

SYSTEM MAP Reader need → allowed inputs → transparent rule or score → ranked candidates → explanation → test record → human decision

What will you add, change, or verify in the project this week?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

What should remain under human control?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Collect only necessary information. Show uncertainty and limits. Never confuse a ranking with a fact about a person.

Evidence for your project

Use progress and stopping arguments for any repeated recommender process; test inputs that require zero, one and several updates.

12. Show what you know

INDEPENDENT MASTERY PROOF

Explain • Transfer • Test • Defend

Complete this page without copying the worked example. Your reasoning matters more than decoration.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

Predict loop counts; repair one infinite loop.

CHALLENGE Predict loop counts; repair one infinite loop.

1. My fresh example, trace, calculation, or design:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

2. My evidence that it works (include a boundary or missing-data case):

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

3. One limitation, fairness concern, or situation needing human review:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

SELF-CHECK ☐ I explained the mechanism ☐ I used evidence ☐ I tested a fresh case ☐ I named a limitation ☐ I can answer 'why?'

13. Study a complete case

Week 5 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

Start $n=0$; while $n<3$, add 1 and record n .

The question

List records and stopping condition.

Worked explanation

1,2,3. The next comparison is false. The update makes progress toward termination.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

A loop must progress toward stopping

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Start n

Value or result: 0

Evidence or stage: First update

Value or result: 1

Evidence or stage: Second update

Value or result: 2

Evidence or stage: Third update

Value or result: 3

Evidence or stage: Next $n < 3$ check

Value or result: False, stop

Start $n=0$; while $n<3$, add 1 and record n.

List records and stopping condition.

1,2,3. The next comparison is false. The update makes progress toward termination.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Changed independent case

Start count at 1. While count < 8 , add 3. Trace the condition and values. What happens if the condition becomes count $\neq 8$?

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 5 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

Start at count 0. While count is less than 3, add 1 and display count. List the displays and the stopping value.

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Loop through every candidate book, update its score, then stop at the end of the list.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

Trace `count=0; while count<4: count=count+2`. List values tested by the condition and final count. Would replacing `<4` with `!=5` terminate?

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a

model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.